

Annotation Tools

Papers/Thesis

([Kim, 2020](#))

Musical

Sonic Visualiser

Sonic Visualiser Forks

- [Tony](#) - high quality pitch and note transcription for scientific applications. It is designed primarily for use with solo vocal recordings.
 - from Matthias Mauch (currently Apple ML Music),¹ Chris Cannam,¹ Rachel Bittner,² George Fazekas,¹ Justin Salamon,² Jiajie Dai,¹ Juan Bello,² Simon Dixon¹
- [Sonic Lineup](#) - Alignment of Renditions of same piece
- Sonic Annotator -
- [Dezrann](#) -
 - **Dezrann** is an open web platform designed to *listen to, study, and annotate music*. It is used in *music education*, as well as for *corpus annotation* in *musicology* and *computational music research*. Users directly interact with *views on music sources*, such as scores, waveforms, grids, or piano rolls. Simply click anywhere on a view to add or edit labels, and shift-click to play from any point.

2025 Roadmap

- Curated collection of 10+ corpora / 1500+ pieces : see [/corpora](#)
- Direct score upload (.midi, .krn, .mei, .mxml)
- Direct audio upload or URL selection from YouTube
- Prototype of an audio/score synchronization tool and demonstrators for the CollabScore project

We also plan to add further *collaborative features* and improve *responsiveness* for mobile and tablet usage. To receive updates on Dezrann, make suggestions, request an account, or ask for new pieces, [drop us a mail](#).

Credits, references

- Charles Ballester et al., *Interacting with annotated and synchronized music corpora on the Dezrann web platform*, Transactions of the International Society for Music Information Retrieval (TISMIR), 2025

- Lou Garczynski, Mathieu Giraud, Emmanuel Leguy, Philippe Rigaux, *Modeling and editing cross-modal synchronization on a label web canvas*, MEC 2022

Piano Precision (A program that assists analyzing recorded piano performances together with their scores.). Adapted from **Sonic Visualiser**, but with an added panel displaying musical scores, and additional features such as audio-to-score alignment. The program needs to be used together with the **aligner plugin**.)

- Programmers: Yucong Jiang (University of Richmond), Chris Cannam,

-**CAAMP: Computer-assisted Annotation and Analysis of Music Performance** (The evolution of Piano Precision)

SIMP (Synchronized Interactive Music Player) - Presented at ISMIR23

- Is related to PianoPrecision/CAAMP - one of the main researchers is the same: Yucong Jiang

Others (Musical)

- **Dezrann**: open web platform designed to *listen to, study, and annotate music*. It is used in *music education*, as well as for *corpus annotation* in *musicology* and *computational music research*. Users directly interact with *views on music sources*, such as scores, waveforms, grids, or piano rolls. Simply click anywhere on a view to add or edit labels, and shift-click to play from any point.

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- *Annotemus*: precise annotation of note and beat onsets (start/end), from RITMO - Oslo. (Lartillot et al., 2023)
- *Soundslice* - for transcription (the one used by Xavier Riley)
- AudioSculpt (IRCAM) - not maintained anymore
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Others Sound (Non-Musical)

- **CrowdCurio Audio Annotator**

A JavaScript-based web interface for annotating audio, with support for region selection, tagging, and workflow management. It leverages wavesurfer.js for visualization and interaction. Jason Salamon, Bello, MARL

Crowsetta

A Python tool to work with any format for annotating animal sounds and bioacoustics data

Other annotation tools:

AI Type - Open-Source

- **i-SED** - (PhD Dissertation+Tool) An open-source data labeling platform that supports audio annotation, including region marking, event labeling, and collaborative workflows. It integrates well with machine learning pipelines. Related to Bryan Pardo and Interactive Audio Lab is in the *Computer Science Department of Northwestern University*.
 - *PhD Dissertation*
 - *Demo*
 -

AI Type - Commercial

- [AudiAnnotate](#)- Workflows for . enerating AV editions and exhibits using IIIF manifests by HiPSTAS and Brumfield Labs.
- [SuperAnnotate](#) - includes Starter Free pack
- Encord
- [Prodigy](#) (NLP)

From [ISMIR-community discussion](#), where Sebastian Stober, where he states:

Note

My team is currently annotating a dataset that contains voice recordings of various speech disorders such as stuttering. The final quality check is going to be done by a domain expert. As most experts, she is very busy. So we would like to support this process through an easily and efficiently usable web-based interface.

The tool should be web-based (self-hosting is not a problem) and be able to load multiple audio signals (displaying one after the other). For each audio (displayed currently), it

- Should be able to play the audio,
- Should be able to select regions and annotate, as in Audacity, and
- Should be able to import existing annotations, as in Audacity.

Overlaying two different annotation on top of each other would also be handy.

- [Brian McFee]
 - Open-Source <https://labelstud.io/> (a bit computer vision focused, but has one NVidia Example with Audio)
- [Thomas Lidy] -
 - Commercial <https://www.superannotate.com/audio-annotation>

Taken from Environmental Sounds

Source: <https://homepages.tuni.fi/toni.heittola/datasets.html>

- <https://github.com/CrowdCurio/audio-annotator>

- <https://www.bongjunkim.com/ised/>
- <https://github.com/BlaiMelendezCatalan/BAT>

Relevant Libraries

wavesurfer.js A popular JavaScript library for visualizing and interacting with audio waveforms in the browser. It supports plugins for region marking and event annotation, making it ideal for building web-based annotation tools. For example, the *audio-annotator* project is built on wavesurfer.js and provides region selection and tagging functionality.